

Furman Conservative Society Constitution

ARTICLE I: Purpose and Status

Section I. In order to advance the conservative principles that founded and sustain this nation, we hereby establish Furman Conservative Society (hereinafter referred to as "FCS") of Furman University.

Section II. FCS works to build a strong community, create vibrant discussion, and challenge and develop ideas, all in an effort to promote conservative values.

ARTICLE II: Conduct

Section I. FCS of Furman University is an official Furman University student organization and shall act in strict compliance with all university rules and regulations.

Section II. FCS of Furman University does not purport to represent the views or opinions of Furman University.

Section III. FCS, as a 501c3, organization will not endorse candidates for office.

ARTICLE III: Membership

Section I. Membership in FCS shall be open to all Furman students who pay the student activity fee. In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

Section II. A voting member is defined as a member who has participated in two FCS sponsored events in a school year, one of which must be a general membership meeting. The other may come from participating in general membership meetings, assisting with speaking events, attending social events or helping with publicity projects. The COO will maintain these attendance records which may be subject to an audit by the Board of Directors or by the membership.

ARTICLE IV: Board of Directors

Section I. The Board of Directors shall consist of the four elected officers from the voting membership listed in Section II and no more than five appointed board members.

Section II. Elected Officers

A. The Chief Executive Officer (CEO) shall be responsible for contact with the Furman University administration, Student Government Association (SGA), members of FCS, and other groups. The CEO presides over all Board of Directors meetings and is responsible for establishing the agenda for general membership meetings. If the CEO is not capable of attending a meeting he/she may delegate another

elected officer to preside over the meeting. The CEO must approve all public documents; however, a majority vote of the Board of Directors may overturn the decision. The CEO may appoint Auxiliary Board Members with the consent, by a simple majority vote, of the entire Board of Directors.

- B. The Chief Financial Officer (CFO) shall oversee the finances of FCS. The CFO is responsible for submitting a proposed budget to SGA, with the approval of the CEO. An accurate record of all income and expenses shall be maintained at all times. Receipts shall be written for all contributions and expenses. The financial records of FCS shall be subject to audit by the Board of Directors at any time. The CFO will comply with all SGA financial management requirements related to university funds and their use and accountability.
- C. The Chief Operating Officer (COO) is ultimately responsible for keeping minutes and attendance but may delegate these duties if seen fit. COO shall be knowledgeable about event planning and execution and be available to assist the organizer(s) of events. COO shall oversee events and make decisions pertaining to events.
- D. The Chief Branding Officer (CBO) shall oversee event publicity and advertising and be responsible for maintaining electronic media. CBO shall oversee the publication of the newsletter, and review all educational material representing FCS in the newsletter, newspapers and social and electronic media. The CBO shall coordinate educational campus activism and other educational activities. The CBO maintains the brand of the organization.

Section III. Appointed Auxiliary Board Members

- A. Appointed Auxiliary Board Members must be voting members of FCS.
- B. Of the five appointed Auxiliary Board Members, up to three spots may be filled in the spring. At least two spots may be filled in the fall. Anyone wishing to become a Board member must first apply in writing to the Executive Board.
- C. Additional Auxiliary Board Members, exceeding the five Auxiliary Board Members, may be appointed by the CEO with unanimous consent of the Board of Directors.
- D. Appointed Auxiliary Board Members terms should start at their appointment and end at the next general election.

Section IV. The Board of Directors shall vote on any pressing decision facing FCS. A pressing decision pertains to any outstanding disagreement between the Board of Directors, in which there is no described solvent, process, or outcome. No member of the Board has veto power. In the case of a tied vote, the voting members of the organization shall break the tie at a meeting. The vote must have been previously announced 24 hours prior to the vote.

Article V: Committees

Section I. Committees may be formed with a majority vote of the Board of Directors in order to address various topics. Committee chairs shall be designated to supervise the activities of each committee also by a majority vote of the Board of Directors.

ARTICLE VI: Election, Removal and Vacating of Positions

Section I. Officers shall be elected annually by the voting members of FCS. Elections shall be held in February, last two weeks, and the term of office shall begin the one week after Spring Break of the same year. The first week is dedicated for nominations and choosing the election commission. The second week will be dedicated to voting. Absentee ballots must be emailed to the head of the election commission before the start of the voting meeting. In the case of a special election, only vacant positions will be filled. Members must be notified of elections and available positions at least two weeks prior to the election.

Section II. All voting members shall have one vote by secret ballot. Any voting member may nominate himself or herself or any other voting member for a position.

A. Any club member eligible to vote is also eligible to run for COO, CFO, and CBO. The CEO candidate must have served on the Board previously. In the event that a candidate for any position is Studying Away, they will, if elected, have the opportunity to choose their replacement for the semester they are gone, provided that the replacement is eligible to vote.

B. Elections will occur in the order positions appear in Article IV. If there is only one contested position, said position will be voted upon first. The order of voting upon positions does not imply any hierarchy among the positions of the Board of Directors.

C. Each candidate will speak for no more than five minutes before a vote takes place. Those who are not elected to a position may be considered for a remaining position.

D. An Election Commission, made up of two members, will be formed the night of elections by the voting members present. Members of the Election Commission will be selected on a volunteer basis and voting members will be given preference. If there are more than two volunteers, voting members present will select the Election Commission by a show of hands. Members of the Election Commission cannot run for office nor nominate or openly support candidates.

E. Any voting member with a second voting member seconding the motion may request the Election Commission to count the ballots out loud and/or display them in plain sight to promote transparency.

Section III. Procedure for removal of an officer shall comply strictly with the following:

A. Voting members may call for the removal of an officer with a majority vote of those present at a general membership meeting. The Board of Directors may call for the removal of an officer with a majority

vote. In either case, a two-week notice of the vote to remove must be given. The first vote is to call for the second vote which is to remove an officer.

- B. The Board Member facing removal must be given an opportunity to present his/her case to the organization at large prior to the vote.
- C. The member shall be removed from the Board of Directors following a 2/3 vote from voting members present at the meeting. A quorum of voting members, following Robert's Rules of Order, must be present for the vote to be held.

Section IV. If an officer position is vacated, besides the CEO position, the CEO must appoint an individual to temporarily fill the position at the next Board Meeting with a majority vote of approval by the Board of Directors. The Board of Directors must call for elections within one month from the appointment to permanently fill the vacated position. The voting membership should be given no less than a two-week notice of this election. If the CEO position is vacated, the COO will serve as interim CEO and the Board Directors must call for an election within one month to fill the CEO position. No less than a two-week notice of the election must be given to the voting membership.

ARTICLE VII: Meetings

Section I. General membership meetings shall be held twice a month during the school year. Additional membership meetings may be held at the discretion of the Board of Directors.

Section II. The Board of Directors shall hold meetings at least twice a month during the school year. Additional meetings may be held at the discretion of the CEO.

ARTICLE VIII: Amendments

Section I. An amendment may be presented by any voting member of FCS and requires a 3/4 majority of voting members present at the meeting in order to be instituted. A two-week notice of the vote must be given to all members of FCS. An emergency vote, held with one week's notice, may be called by a majority vote of the Board of Directors.

Section II. All amendments must be submitted to and approved by SGA after their endorsement by FCS.

ARTICLE IX: Advisor

Section I. The faculty/staff advisor is chosen or removed by a 3/4 vote of the Board of Directors.

- A. The advisor must meet SGA guidelines.

FACULTY ADVISORS:

Shane Farmer, Assistant Director of Student Activities and the Trone Student Center

ARTICLE X: Events

Section I: FCS will host a yearly banquet to celebrate the year's success, honor the outgoing seniors, and provide a final social opportunity for the group before final examinations. The banquet will be held in the second half of the Spring semester. In order for a member to be eligible for banquet attendance, they must have attended four club meetings/events (only one which may be a social event) throughout the course of the year OR have attended three club meetings (only one of which may be a social event) in the semester the banquet is held.

Section II: Each spring, FCS will sponsor a trip for a select number of members to travel off-campus for a rich educational experience that informs club members about conservatism. This trip may take the form of a conference, historical tour, or other experience. In order for a club member to be eligible to apply for the spring trip, they must be in good standing with the club and engage faithfully in group meetings and discussion. A student Studying Away in the Fall semester is still eligible to apply for the Spring trip, given that they meet the above requirements. As a part of the selection process, the Board will accept applications from club members, which will then be reviewed and voted on by the entire Board.

[new as of June 22, 2021]